Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K J ♥ A Q 3 ♦ A 4 3 ♣ K 10 4 2	
♠ 10 9 6 3 ♥ 10 8 5 2 ♦ Q 10 9 ♣ J 6	N / W E / S	♠ Q 8 2 ♥ J 6 4 ♦ J 7 5 ♣ 9 8 7 3
	♠ 7 5 4 ♥ K 9 7 ♦ K 8 6 2 ♣ A Q 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2NT	Pass	4NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by North

Partner's 4NT bid is not Blackwood, it is the Quantitative 4NT. He is unsure whether to bid 6NT or not, so is inviting you to do so.

With 20 points you are supposed to pass. With 21 points you are supposed to bid 6NT. The evaluations probably aren't that accurate, but at least you have an excuse to bid 6NT.

North plays 6NT. East leads the ♣9. West plays the ♣J which you take with your ♣K.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 4 :: Total = 11

There are two places you might find your twelfth winner. You can finesse West for the ♠Q; this is a 50% chance. Or, the ♦s might split 3-3; this is about a 40% chance.

If you try the ♠ finesse and it fails you will go down even if the ♦s are splitting 3-3.

If you play ♦A, ♦K then another ♦, a 4-2 ♦ split will defeat you even if the ♠Q was with West.

Two chances are always better than one. The way to take both chances is to duck a ♦ at trick 2. Win whatever the defenders play next and then test the ♦s. If they do split your last ♦ will be trick #12. But if they don't split you can still try the ♠ finesse.

Ducking the ♦ was the correct play - not just because it worked, but because it gave you the opportunity to try an alternate method if it didn't work.

Board 3
East Deals
E-W Vul

North:
♠ Q 10 5 4
♥ A 8 4 2
♦ 9 6 3
♣ 10 7

West		East
♠ A 9	N	♠ K 8 6 2
♥ Q 10 6 3	W E	♥ 7 5
♦ 8 5 2	S	♦ A K 7
♣ Q J 9 4		♣ A K 6 3

South:
♠ J 7 3
♥ K J 9
♦ Q J 10 4
♣ 8 5 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by East

With 9 points you have just enough to respond. And with a 4-card Major suit you should use Stayman so you bid 2♣. Partner duly replies 2♠.

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You don't have a 4-4 ♥ fit, so you invite the notrump game by bidding 2NT. Partner raises to 3NT.

The contract would be 3NT played by West.

East plays 3NT and South leads the ♦Q. Should you win or hold up?

A pretty good argument against holding up could be that they might switch to ♠s. However, say you do in fact hold up and that South does in fact continue ♦s with North following suit.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 4 :: Total = 8

Don't worry any more about the ♦s since there is nothing more you can do. Instead, worry about where that one more winner is going to come from. The answer will have to be: *from the ♥ suit*.

You might be tempted to take your 4 ♣ tricks right away, but avoid the temptation. The ♣ suit is your convenient transportation back and forth between hands.

You will have to lose at least 2 ♥ tricks in order to set up 1 winner, and by the time you do that the defenders will have established at least 1 more ♦ trick. What that means is that you cannot afford 3 ♥ losers. So how will you play the ♥s?

You should play South for the ♥J plus one of the big ones. This is a better chance than playing him for both the ♥ A K. So play a ♥ toward dummy and insert the ♥10 when South plays low. North wins with the ♥A and clears the ♦s. Play another ♥ toward dummy's ♥Q. South can take his ♥K and cash his ♦ winner but dummy's ♥Q will be your ninth trick.

There were two ♥ distributions which would allow you to make this contract.

South could hold both the ♥A and ♥K, in which case leading toward dummy's ♥Q would be the winning play.

South could hold **EITHER** ♥ A J x **OR**♥ K J x in which case finessing dummy's ♥J would be the winning play. This is the more likely distribution of the two.